Learner Handbook

WELCOME

The Data Science and Machine Learning Program by MIT IDSS is delivered in collaboration with Great Learning's unique learning delivery model that combines a live interactive online classroom experience and continuous learner support to ensure successful learning outcomes. The program aims to build industry-valued skills and to prepare you to participate in or lead data science efforts at any organization.

This handbook is designed to orient you to the many resources and opportunities available to you as you begin your journey here. Use this guide to maximize your learning outcomes.

PROGRAM STRUCTURE

This is a rigorous program and requires dedication and commitment from you to achieve learning outcomes. On average, you will need to dedicate 8-12 hours of time every week towards learning. It is critical that you follow the timelines and keep up with the program otherwise you risk falling significantly behind, from where it becomes very difficult to catch up. There are several mechanisms such as reminders and notifications built into the system to help you maintain the schedule, but the most important requirement is your commitment.

Participants are expected to take almost 3 months to complete this Program.

- The course involves recorded lectures by MIT Faculty and interactive live mentored learning sessions by Industry Professionals
- A course may be split into one or two weeks
- Each week comprises recorded lectures, self-study, practice exercises,mandatory live mentored learning sessions, additional hands-on sessions(optional) and conceptual sessions (optional) along with the assessments.

PEDAGOGY

The recorded lectures are delivered by world-class faculty who are associated with MIT IDSS. This ensures that the program imbibes academic elegance as well as industry relevance, thereby providing learners with a comprehensive learning experience.

MENTORED LEARNING SESSIONS (MLS)

Mentored Learning Sessions are weekly live online learning sessions conducted by industry professionals for a group of 15-16 learners. These small groups enable learners to be more engaged and participative. These sessions are an integral part of the program.

Objectives of MLS:

- To gain clarity on concepts covered in the course during the week by the way of questions and answers
- To collaborate on a hands-on case study led by the mentor. Learning to actually work on data is very important to the successful completion of the programs
- To gain an industry perspective via the examples and experiences shared by the mentors

Preparing for Mentoring Session

- Prior to the mentoring session, you will receive an announcement regarding the agenda of the session.
- Participants are expected to watch all the recorded lectures completely before attending the mentored learning sessions.
- You are expected to post your questions before the mentoring session so that your queries are resolved in a systematic way. You are also expected to stay on track with the schedule so that you are able to follow what is being taught.

TECHNOLOGY ENABLED ONLINE LEARNING

Learning Management System (LMS) Olympus online learning, facilitated through a state-of-the-art, world-class, Learning Management System (LMS) is an integral part of the program. The LMS is your primary information and communication exchange mechanism. It will provide access to the learning material that is part of various courses. This includes a class schedule, case studies, exercise, and quizzes. It also has a mechanism for you to communicate with the Program Office.

After you log in to the LMS please do the following:

. Update your profile with the correct name to be published in the certificate
. Update your notification preferences
. Read through the documents on how to use the LMS

Mentored Learning Sessions Platform:

- Online mentored learning sessions will be conducted on Zoom. Participants are expected to download zoom from zoom.us.
- The auto-generated email will have the link to join the session, requesting you to please use the same.
- In case you do not log in for that specific link your attendance shall not be captured.

PROGRAM EVALUATION

The program curriculum consists of a combination of recorded lectures, mentor learning sessions, weekly assessments, and projects. While we encourage collaboration, we expect students to adhere to the highest standards of ethics and avoid plagiarism and copying. Given that you are all experienced.

Professionals who are pursuing this program with the primary objective of learning, are expected to follow the honour code and not indulge in unethical behaviour or plagiarism.

COMMUNICATIONS

The program office is your partner in ensuring you achieve the desired learning outcomes. Use the following means to communicate to the Program Office and with your peers to get a timely response to your queries.

1. Support requests on the Olympus

Learners can use the option of 'Need Assistance', or what we commonly call Support Requests, to ask for any academic or non-academic query from the program office and support team. All non-academic queries are attended by the Program Management team and all the academic support queries are attended by a team of data scientists acting as TAs to MIT faculty and Industry Mentors.

An academic query can of any of the following types, and beyond,

- Clarifications on the course concepts
- Clarifications on assignments or quizzes
- Discussions on course material
- Clarifications on missing data sets, course material or recordings, etc

2. Announcements

Program Office may also communicate with you when important information has to be solicited, shared, or in response to your questions. The program office will post an announcement when new course material is available if there are any changes to upcoming courses and other program-related issues. These announcements will appear on your home page of the LMS. Please ensure that you log in regularly and pay attention to any new announcements to ensure that important information is not missed. You can also modify your communication preferences so that an automated email is sent to you whenever a new announcement is made.

3. Notifications

Notifications are automated system-generated messages sent to all participants whenever important new information is available. These may involve the availability of grades, reminders for an upcoming assessment due date, and when assessments are released. These notifications will also appear on your home page of the LMS. You may again modify your communication preferences to receive an email whenever a notification is made.

Course Scoring and Evaluation

Marks Distribution

The evaluation of academic performance in each course is based on the following components. Marks for each component, out of 100, are also mentioned below.

Weekly Quizzes	90 marks for courses without project 50 marks for courses with project
Project	40 marks

	(There will be a total of 3 projects in the program)
Attendance - Mentored Learning Sessions	10 marks per course

Participants need to score a minimum of overall **60%** to complete a course from the above-listed components.

Course Completion

You will be scored as follows:

Criteria	Scoring
Less than 60 %	IC (Incomplete)
60-80 %	C (Complete)
80-100 %	E (Excel)

Attendance Points:

Attending Mentoring sessions is a must to be eligible for 10 marks of attendance. If a participant is not able to attend any session due to medical/personal reasons or official tours, he/she has to intimate in advance.

Extension Policy:

The assessments will be released on Learning Management System (Olympus) along with video content for each week and should be submitted on or before the due dates mentioned.

No submissions will be accepted after the due date.

- There will be only 1 extension (throughout the program) for Quizzes/Projects in case you fail to submit the assessment on or before the deadline.
- Extensions** can be availed on a case-by-case basis for the assessments. You can reach out to your Program Manager or raise a support ticket with the request for an extension.

**Note - Only in critical circumstances, you can avail of an extension based on the extension policy.

Program Completion Criterion

For successfully completing the MIT-DSML Program and to be eligible for the certificate, you will be required to complete all the courses with a minimum of 60 percent per module.

FEE PAYMENTS

. In case of non-payment or delay in payment of fees as per the schedule mentioned in the admission offer letter, your Learning Management System (LMS) will be disabled automatically and will become active only once the payment for the due installment is made.
. Extensions in fee payment are not allowed.

Once again, congratulations and welcome as you begin your journey with Great Learning. Since DSML is a rigorous program, you will find that there may be many challenges – academic and personal. But remember that we are here to encourage and support you as you meet your learning objectives and achieve your career aspirations.

Happy Learning!!

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